

# Asus Zenbook A14

Ultra-light and built to last

**A**s someone who relies heavily on a lightweight laptop to stay

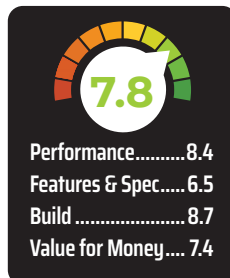
productive on the go, my daily routine often involves squeezing work into long cab rides. I live quite far from my office, and over the years, I've developed a habit of turning commute hours into quiet pockets of focus. This means that a laptop needs to be light enough to use comfortably on my lap, powerful enough to run all my apps without stutter, and efficient enough to last through at least 4 hours of commute time, along with the usual 8 to 9 working hours. So when I switched to the Asus Zenbook A14, I was curious to see whether it could truly keep up with this on-the-move lifestyle. And after using the laptop for a month, I think I am pretty convinced that it can.

Priced at Rs 1,29,990, but often available for around Rs 89,000, this laptop enters a competitive premium ultrabook space, especially with Qualcomm's new Snapdragon X Elite platform powering it. Asus promises excellent portability, long battery life, and AI-ready performance. But does it live up to those claims in real life? Let's dive in.

## ASUS ZENBOOK A14: DESIGN AND CONNECTIVITY

The Asus Zenbook A14 immediately strikes you with its premium, minimal aesthetic. The company has kept the design clean and refined, and the laptop feels incredibly compact once you pick it up. At just 0.9 kg, it is one of the lightest 14-inch laptops I have used, and

₹1,29,990



this makes a genuine difference when you're carrying it around all day or pulling it out in a moving cab.

The construction feels solid, and the hinge deserves special appreciation. I didn't notice any wobble while typing or adjusting the angle, and there's a sturdy reassurance in the way it opens and closes. As someone who has experienced flimsy hinges on thin laptops before, this stability stood out. The fit and finish of the chassis also feel premium, with a matte texture and neat curves that make the whole device look polished.

Asus still gives you one USB Type-A port, which is great, but one more would have made everyday use noticeably easier. I often connect both a keyboard and a mouse to my laptop at work, so having just one Type-A port meant depending on an adapter more than I'd have liked. On the positive side, you do get two USB-C ports, HDMI, and a combo audio jack.

The keyboard is spacious, well-spread, and comfortable to type on for long stretches. And yes, you get a dedicated Copilot key that opens Microsoft's AI assistant instantly, which genuinely came in handy more than once. The trackpad also does its job well. It's smooth, responsive, and sized just right. Not too large that your palms brush against it accidentally, and not too small that you feel cramped while navigating.

## DISPLAY AND SPEAKERS

The Asus Zenbook A14 features a 14-inch 2.8K 60 Hz display, and in real-world usage, it looks sharp, vibrant, and plenty bright for both work and casual content consumption. During my testing with Calman,

the display reached around 400 nits of peak brightness and offered 96.5% sRGB and 78.4% DCI-P3 coverage. Colour accuracy is solid too, with an average Delta E of just 1, which is impressive.

I was easily able to use the Zenbook A14 in a car during the day. Movies and YouTube videos looked crisp, text appeared super sharp, and the higher resolution made multitasking feel comfortable without needing to squint or zoom.

The speakers, however, are a mixed bag. They are loud enough for video calls and casual watching, but the richness and depth you expect from a premium ultrabook aren't quite there. At this price, a step up in sound quality would've completed the multimedia experience. For the best audio, headphones are definitely the way to go.

## PERFORMANCE AND BENCHMARKS

Powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon X Elite processor and 16 GB of LPDDR5X RAM, the Asus Zenbook A14 felt snappy and fluid in real-world tasks.

Whether I was juggling multiple Chrome tabs, writing documents, attending calls, or switching between apps during the commute, the laptop